

Title: The Most Common Emergencies at Home [Article]

Excerpt: Household emergencies happen far too often, and many times, the people affected by them weren't properly prepared. This can lead to emergencies like heart attacks and strokes, which are addressed in this article along with the medical procedures to prevent and save someone from these emergencies.

Author: Lydia Xia

Editor: Ethan Tai

Date: 4/12/2026

Read Time: 3 mins

Household emergencies are incredibly common, and unfortunately, most individuals are not properly prepared. The [National Center for Health Statistics](#) states in the U.S. alone, there are over 155 million household medical emergencies, with 73% of life-threatening incidents happening in private residences. The most common emergencies that occur in everyday home settings include heart attacks, choking, strokes, allergic reactions, severe burns, and falls. Although this list may seem daunting and widespread, just a little preparation can be incredibly impactful.

Heart attacks are especially prevalent in those with heart conditions such as elderly folk, and can happen at any given moment. Knowing the warning signs and preparing properly can save a life. [UMass Memorial Health](#) instructs to call 911 immediately if you suspect someone is having a heart attack, and not allow the patient to drive to the hospital themselves as this can pose a great risk to them and those around them. While waiting for emergency help to arrive, ensure the front door is unlocked, a phone is with you, and keep allergens in mind as aspirin may be administered.

A stroke is another common medical emergency that requires immediate action. If someone around you could be having a stroke, record the time symptoms start. According to the [Mayo Clinic](#), common stroke symptoms include trouble speaking/understanding others, numbness or paralysis, eyesight problems, headaches, and difficulty walking. Remember the acronym "FAST" and administer the following:

1. Face: Ask the person to smile. Has their face or mouth dropped?
2. Arms: Ask the person to raise their arms. Can they do it? Does one arm droop?

3. Speech: Ask the person to repeat a simple phrase. Is their speech slurred?
4. Time: If you see any of these signs, immediately call 911.

It is vital to call 911 immediately, and not wait to see if symptoms stop naturally. As time goes on and the stroke continues to go untreated, the risk of brain damage and disability increases dramatically. It is important to keep the patient under careful watch as emergency help is on the way.

Choking is dangerous due to its sudden nature during meals. If someone around you is choking, remember to stay calm in order to make thoughtful decisions. The [Cleveland Clinic](#) writes to not attempt first aid if the individual is coughing with sound, and to not leave them alone during the incident. They are likely to cough up the object on their own. Secondly, trying to remove the object can cause further damage by pushing the object deeper. Only attempt removal if you can see the object. In this case, use your index finger to hook the object and pull it out. If they show signs of complete choking, immediately call 911 and begin first aid. Put the phone on speaker to not delay first aid, and administer the following:

1. Stand to the side and slightly behind them.
2. Lean them slightly forward.
3. Support their chest with your nondominant hand.
4. Using the base of your dominant hand, strike between their shoulder blades five times (back blows)
5. If the object has not been removed, and you are trained in the Heimlich maneuver, otherwise known as abdominal thrusts, administer five times.

It is important to note that administering back blows/the Heimlich maneuver can be lifesaving but also can cause damage to organs and bones. That being said, it is important to seek medical care even if the person seems fine.

Household emergencies are not to be taken lightly, and one of the very first steps should always be calling 911. Additionally, these incidents should also always be followed up on by a healthcare professional to ensure safety in the future. As implausible as these situations may appear, medical emergencies can happen to anyone at any time.

Bibliography

Centers for Disease Control and Prevention. (2024, October 25). FastStats – Emergency Department Visits. Centers for Disease Control and Prevention.

<https://www.cdc.gov/nchs/fastats/emergency-department.htm>

analytics@agency102.com. (2025, September 23). How to Prepare for a Medical Emergency At Home – FCVFD. FCVFD.

<https://fallschurchurchfire.org/how-to-prepare-for-a-medical-emergency-at-home/>

911 Basics: Responding to a Heart Attack | UMass Memorial Health. (2025). Ummhealth.org.

<https://www.ummhealth.org/health-library/911-basics-responding-to-a-heart-attack>

Brown, R. (2024). Stroke. Mayo Clinic.

<https://www.mayoclinic.org/diseases-conditions/stroke/symptoms-causes/syc-20350113>

Choking First Aid and Prevention. (2025, March 28). Cleveland Clinic.

<https://my.clevelandclinic.org/health/diseases/choking>